IELTS SPEAKING • TOPIC 22

FESTIVALS

Natural collocations • Advanced grammar structures • Sample answer

PART 1 • QUESTIONS

- What festivals are popular in your country?
- How do you usually celebrate holidays?
- Do you like crowded celebrations?

PART 2 • CUE CARD

Describe a festival or celebration.

You should say:

- what it is
- when it takes place
- what people do
- why you enjoy it

PART 3 • QUESTIONS

- Why are traditional festivals important?
- Are festivals becoming too commercial?
- Do young people still care about traditions?

50	12	62	25	124
collocations	structures	Band 8 stories	quick upgrades	your sentences

START HERE

One plan for every “festivals” card

- A festival in your country
- A traditional celebration
- A family gathering you enjoyed
- A public holiday you like
- A religious or cultural event
- A celebration you attended recently
- A street parade or fair
- A festival you would like to see abroad

What the festival is → **When** it takes place → **What** people do → **Why** you enjoy it

HOW TO READ EACH CARD

Tarjima + definition — o‘zbekcha ma’nosi va oddiy inglizcha izohi.

Band 8 story — iborani ro‘yxat emas, mini hikoya ichida ishlatish namunasi.

≈ Yaqin iboralar — shu ma’noga yaqin yana 2 ta natural ibora.

Qachon ishlatiladi — qaysi vaziyatda va qanday grammatika bilan.

Namuna gap — bitta tayyor gap. Keyin o‘zingiz 2 ta gap yozing.

Speaking ball — shu ibora gapirishda qanchalik foydali (10 dan).

10 / 10	Signature ibora: Band 8 ni ko‘rsatadi, ko‘p topiclarda ishlaydi.
8–9	Kuchli va moslashuvchan: tabiiy eshitiladi, ball oshiradi.
6–7	Foydali va ishonchli: asos sifatida yaxshi.
4–5	Vaziyatga bog‘liq yoki oddiyroq: faqat mos kelganda ishlating.

Preparing for the celebration

COLLOCATIONS 1 / 5

1 get into the festive spirit

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

bayramona kayfiyatga kirmoq • *to start feeling happy and excited because a celebration is near*

BAND 8 STORY

Two weeks before Navruz, my mother starts baking samsa and hanging lights in the yard, and that's when I **get into the festive spirit**. By the time the first sumalak pot is on the fire, I'm already humming spring songs.

≈ **feel the holiday mood** — bayram kayfiyatini his qilmoq

≈ **catch the festive mood** — bayramona kayfiyatga tushmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bayramdan oldingi tayyorgarlik haqida: get into the festive spirit ('the' bilan). Norasmiy va iliq; Part 1 dagi 'How do you celebrate holidays?' savoliga mos.

Namuna gap: The decorations in the city centre really help me **get into the festive spirit**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 put up decorations

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

bezaklar osmoq, bezatmoq • *to hang lights, flags or ornaments to make a place look special*

BAND 8 STORY

On the eve of Independence Day, my neighbours **put up decorations** along the whole street: flags, paper flowers and strings of colourful bulbs. Walking home that night felt like entering a different world.

≈ **hang lights and flags** — chiroq va bayroqlar osmoq

≈ **deck out the street** — ko'chani bezamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bezash haqida: put up decorations / lights / flags. 'put up' ajraladi: put them up. Part 1 va 2 da tayyorgarlikni ko'rsatishga yordam beradi.

Namuna gap: We usually **put up decorations** a week before the holiday begins.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 bring the whole family together

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

butun oilani bir joyga to'plamoq • *to make all relatives meet in the same place*

BAND 8 STORY

Hayit is the only time of year when my uncles from Namangan and my cousins from Tashkent all sit at one table. The holiday **brings the whole family together**, and honestly that matters more to me than the food.

≈ **reunite the family** — oilani birlashtirmoq

≈ **gather the clan** — katta oilani yig'moq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bayramning oilaviy ahamiyati haqida: bring + odamlar + together. 'bring together' ajratib ham ishlatiladi: bring everyone together. Part 2 da 'why you enjoy it' uchun juda mos.

Namuna gap: A big festival **brings the whole family together**, even those who live abroad.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 a mouth-watering feast

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

og‘iz suvini keltiradigan dasturxon • *a large, delicious meal that makes you feel very hungry*

BAND 8 STORY

After the morning prayer, my grandmother laid out **a mouth-watering feast**: plov, fresh bread, dried fruit and three kinds of salad. We could hardly wait for the oldest uncle to say the first word.

≈ **a lavish spread** — dabdabali dasturxon

≈ **a banquet fit for a king** — shohona ziyofat

Qachon ishlatiladi: Taomni jonli tasvirlash: a mouth-watering feast / aroma / dish. ‘mouth-watering‘ chiziqcha bilan yoziladi. Part 2 da ‘what people do‘ qismiga mos.

Namuna gap: Every Eid, my aunt prepares **a mouth-watering feast** for thirty guests.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 count down the days

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

kunlarni sanab kutmoq • *to wait impatiently because something exciting will happen soon*

BAND 8 STORY

As a kid, I used to **count down the days** until Navruz because it meant new clothes and no homework. I even marked the calendar with red stars, and my sister laughed at me every single morning.

≈ **can’t wait for** — sabrsizlik bilan kutmoq

≈ **look forward to** — intizor bo‘lib kutmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hayajon bilan kutishni ko‘rsatadi: count down the days until + bayram/sana. Part 1 da bolalik va bayramlar haqida juda tabiiy.

Namuna gap: My little brother is already **counting down the days** until the holiday starts.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 spring-clean the house

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

uyni to‘liq tozalab chiqmoq • *to clean a house very thoroughly, often before a festival*

BAND 8 STORY

Before Navruz, my mother insists that we **spring-clean the house** from top to bottom. We wash the carpets, polish the windows and throw away anything broken, and when we finish, the whole house smells of fresh air.

≈ **give the house a deep clean** — uyni sinchiklab tozalamoq

≈ **tidy up from top to bottom** — tepadan pastgacha yig‘ishtirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: spring-clean (chiziqcha bilan) — uyni to‘liq tozalamoq; ot sifatida: a spring-clean. Navruz va bayram tayyorgarligi haqida Part 1 va 2 da tabiiy.

Namuna gap: Many families **spring-clean the house** just before the holiday begins.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 stock up on

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ni ko‘p miqdorda zaxiralamoq • *to buy a large amount of something so that you have enough*

BAND 8 STORY

A week before Hayit, the bazaar is crowded because everyone wants to **stock up on** flour, oil and dried fruit. My father always goes at six in the morning, and he comes back with bags that are almost too heavy for him.

≈ **buy in bulk** — ulgurji sotib olmoq

≈ **lay in supplies** — zaxira yig‘moq

Qachon ishlatiladi: stock up on + ot: stock up on food / supplies. ‘stock up’ ajralmas; ‘on’ predlogi kerak. Bayram oldidan xarid haqida Part 2 da.

Namuna gap: We usually **stock up on** sweets and fruit before guests arrive.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 set the table

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

dasturxon yozmoq, stol tuzamoq • *to put plates, cups and food on the table before a meal*

BAND 8 STORY

On the morning of the holiday, my sisters and I **set the table** with our best cups and a pile of sweets in the middle. Guests usually arrive at ten, and the table looks like a small museum of Uzbek hospitality.

≈ **lay the table** — stol yozmoq

≈ **put out the food** — taomlarni qo‘ymoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: set / lay the table — odatiy ibora (‘the’ bilan). O‘zbekcha ‘dasturxon yozmoq’ga mos. Oila bayrami haqida Part 1 va 2 da.

Namuna gap: It’s my job to **set the table** before the guests come.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 chip in

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

pul yoki mehnat bilan hissa qo‘shmoq • *to give a small amount of money or help so that a group can do something*

BAND 8 STORY

In our mahalla, everyone **chips in** for the holiday concert: some bring money, others bring chairs, and the older women cook. Nobody is forced, but nobody wants to be left out.

≈ **contribute a little** — ozgina hissa qo‘shmoq

≈ **pull together** — birlashib harakat qilmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(fe’l) gapga aralashmoq — ‘It’s true,’ she **chipped in**, ‘we should leave now.’

Qachon ishlatiladi: chip in (for + ot / to + fe’l). Norasmiy phrasal verb. Mahalla va jamoa ishlari haqida Part 2 va 3 da mos.

Namuna gap: Neighbours **chip in** to decorate the street every year.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 make elaborate preparations

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

puxta tayyorgarlik ko‘rmoq • *to prepare very carefully and with many details*

BAND 8 STORY

For Navruz, my aunts **make elaborate preparations** for weeks: menus, seating plans, even a schedule for who washes the dishes. It feels like organising a small festival, and honestly it always works perfectly.

≈ **plan down to the last detail** — mayda-chuydasigacha rejalashtirmoq

≈ **go to great lengths** — juda ko‘p urinmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: make preparations (for + ot); ‘elaborate’ — murakkab, puxta. ‘do preparations’ demang. Part 2 da tayyorgarlik haqida gapirishda.

Namuna gap: Families **make elaborate preparations** for the biggest holiday of the year.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 the streets come alive

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ko'chalar jonlanadi • *a place suddenly becomes full of people, noise and energy*

BAND 8 STORY
As soon as the sun goes down during Navruz, **the streets come alive** with music, dancing and kids with sparklers. Even my shy grandfather stands at the gate, clapping to the rhythm of the doira.

≈ **the city bursts into life** — shahar birdan jonlanadi

≈ **the place buzzes with energy** — joy energiyaga to'ladi

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) yuzi yorishmoq, jonlanmoq — She **came alive** when the music began.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bayram tasvirida: come alive (o'timsiz fe'l). 'come to life' ham to'g'ri. Part 2 da 'what people do' qismiga jonlilik qo'shadi.

Namuna gap: On festival nights, the whole old town **comes alive** with lanterns and street performers.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 dress up in traditional clothes

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

milliy kiyimlarda kiyinmoq • *to wear special old-style clothes of your culture on a special day*

BAND 8 STORY
On Independence Day, my little cousins **dress up in traditional clothes**, with embroidered doppi caps and bright atlas dresses. They look so adorable that every relative wants a photo with them.

≈ **wear national costumes** — milliy libos kiymoq

≈ **put on festive outfits** — bayramona kiyimlar kiymoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: dress up in + kiyim turi. 'dress up' — chiroyli kiyinmoq, norasmiy. 'wear' dan jonliroq; Part 1 va 2 da bayram odatlarini aytishda mos.

Namuna gap: Many people **dress up in traditional clothes** to show pride in their heritage.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

13 take part in the festivities

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

bayram tadbirlarida qatnashmoq • *to join the events, games and celebrations of a festival*

BAND 8 STORY
I'm usually shy, but last Navruz I decided to **take part in the festivities** instead of just watching. I joined a tug-of-war at the park, lost badly, and laughed harder than I had in months.

≈ **join in the fun** — tadbirlarga qo'shilmoq

≈ **get involved in the celebrations** — bayramda faol qatnashmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: take part in + tadbir. 'festivities' doim ko'plikda. Biroz rasmiyroq; kundalik tilda 'join in'. Part 1 va 2 da ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Everyone in our mahalla **takes part in the festivities**, from toddlers to grandparents.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

14 light up the sky

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

osmonni yoritmoq • *to fill the night sky with bright colours or lights*

BAND 8 STORY
At midnight, fireworks **lit up the sky** above the Registan, and the whole crowd went silent for a second. Then came a roar of applause, and I felt goosebumps all over my arms.

≈ **paint the sky with colour** — osmonni ranglarga bo‘yamoq

≈ **illuminate the night sky** — tungi osmonni yoritmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO
(fe’l) (yuz) yorishib ketmoq — Her face **lit up** when she saw the cake.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Fireworks / lanterns light up the sky. ‘light up’ tartibsiz fe’l: lit up. Kechki bayram manzarasini tasvirlashda yaxshi; Part 2 uchun.

Namuna gap: Hundreds of lanterns **lit up the sky** as the festival reached its peak.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

15 dance the night away

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tun bo‘yi raqsga tushmoq • *to dance for many hours until very late*

BAND 8 STORY
After the Navruz concert, we **danced the night away** in the courtyard. By two o’clock my feet were aching, but nobody wanted the music to stop.

≈ **party until dawn** — tongga qadar ziyofat qilmoq

≈ **dance until we dropped** — charchab yiqilguncha raqsga tushmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom, norasmiy: dance the night away. ‘away’ ni tushirib qoldirmang. Quvonchni ko‘rsatadi; Part 2 da ko‘ngilochar kechani tasvirlashda.

Namuna gap: Young people love to **dance the night away** at open-air concerts during the holidays.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

16 a colourful procession

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

rang-barang yurish, karnaval • *a line of people walking together in bright clothes at a celebration*

BAND 8 STORY
At Navruz, **a colourful procession** of dancers in silk dresses moved through the main square, with drummers leading the way. Children ran alongside them, trying to touch the bright ribbons.

≈ **a lively parade** — jonli karnaval

≈ **a festive march** — bayram yurishi

Qachon ishlatiladi: a colourful procession / parade. ‘procession’ — marosimiy yurish, ‘parade’ dan rasmiyroq. Part 2 da ‘what people do’ bandi uchun mos.

Namuna gap: **A colourful procession** of musicians passed our house at noon.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

17 fill the air

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

havoni to‘ldirmoq • *to be so strong in a place that you notice it everywhere (sound or smell)*

BAND 8 STORY

The smell of grilled meat and fresh bread **filled the air** as we walked into the park. Somewhere a singer started a folk song, and my stomach and my heart both began to dance.

≈ **hang in the air** — havoda muallaq bo‘lmoq

≈ **drift through the streets** — ko‘chalarga taralmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: X fills the air (smell, music, laughter). Sezgilarni tasvirlashda chiroyli ibora: the aroma of … fills the air. Part 2 da jonli bo‘ladi.

Namuna gap: The sound of drums **filled the air** as the parade began.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

18 gather around the table

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

dasturxon atrofiga yig‘ilmoq • *to come together and sit around a table to eat and talk*

BAND 8 STORY

After the prayer, all of us **gathered around the table**, from my grandfather to the youngest baby. Everyone talked at the same time, and the teapot was refilled so many times I lost count.

≈ **sit down together** — birga o‘tirmoq

≈ **come together for a meal** — taom uchun yig‘ilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: gather around + the table / the fire. ‘gather’ — to‘planmoq, ‘around’ predlogi. Oilaviy bayram suhbatida Part 1 va 2 da.

Namuna gap: On New Year’s Eve we **gather around the table** and make wishes.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

19 exchange greetings

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

bir-birini tabriklamoq • *to say kind words to each other when you meet on a special day*

BAND 8 STORY

On the first morning of Hayit, neighbours **exchange greetings** at the gate, hug and invite each other in. Even people who argued during the year seem to forget it all in those few minutes.

≈ **wish each other well** — bir-biriga omad tilamoq

≈ **congratulate one another** — bir-birini tabriklamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: exchange greetings / gifts / smiles. ‘exchange’ — ikki tomonlama. ‘Hayit muborak’ deyishni tasvirlashda mos; biroz rasmiy. Part 2 da.

Namuna gap: People **exchange greetings** and small gifts when they visit relatives.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

20 line the streets

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

ko‘chaning ikki yonida saf tortmoq • *to stand in rows along both sides of a road to watch something*

BAND 8 STORY

Thousands of people **lined the streets** to watch the parade, many holding flags and phones in the air. I climbed on a low wall, and from there the whole road looked like a river of colour.

≈ **crowd the pavements** — yo‘laklarni to‘ldirmoq

≈ **stand shoulder to shoulder** — yelkama-yelka turmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: crowds line the streets (o‘timli fe’l). ‘line’ — qatorga tizilmoq. Katta bayram yoki parad tasviri uchun; Part 2 da yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Spectators **lined the streets** to welcome the dancers.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

21 be passed down from generation to generation

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

avloddan avlodga o‘tmoq • *to be taught by parents and grandparents to their children over many years*

BAND 8 STORY
Our recipe for sumalak **has been passed down from generation to generation**. My great-grandmother taught my grandmother, who taught my mother, and last year I finally stirred the pot all night myself.

≈ **be handed down through the years** — yillar davomida meros bo‘lmoq

≈ **be inherited from our ancestors** — ota-bobolardan meros qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Urf-odat, retsept, qo‘shiq haqida: be passed down (passiv) + from generation to generation. ‘generation’ birlikda! Part 3 an’ana savollarida kuchli.

Namuna gap: Many folk dances **are passed down from generation to generation** during festivals.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

22 keep a tradition alive

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

an’anani saqlab qolmoq • *to continue a custom so that it does not disappear*

BAND 8 STORY
Most of my friends think cooking over a fire is old-fashioned, but my father insists on it. He says it’s the only way to **keep a tradition alive**, and, to be fair, nothing tastes better than his kazan kebab.

≈ **preserve customs** — urf-odatlarni asramoq

≈ **carry on a tradition** — an’anani davom ettirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: keep + an’ana + alive (‘alive’ oxirida turadi). ‘keep alive a tradition’ tabiiy emas. Part 3 dagi ‘Do young people still care?’ savoliga juda mos.

Namuna gap: Schools can help **keep a tradition alive** by organising festival days.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

23 deeply rooted in tradition

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

an’anaga chuqur ildiz otgan • *having existed for a very long time and being part of a culture’s history*

BAND 8 STORY
Navruz is **deeply rooted in tradition**; people were celebrating it in Central Asia thousands of years ago. When I jump over a small fire with my cousins, I feel connected to everyone who did it before me.

≈ **firmly established in culture** — madaniyatda mustahkam o‘rnashgan

≈ **have ancient origins** — qadimiy ildizlarga ega bo‘lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: be deeply rooted in + tradition / culture / history. ‘in’ predlogi muhim. Biroz rasmiyroq; Part 3 da an’ana haqida gapirganda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Most festivals here are **deeply rooted in tradition**, which makes them hard to change.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

24 cultural heritage

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

madaniy meros • *the customs, buildings and art that a country keeps from the past*

BAND 8 STORY

My history teacher once said that festivals are living **cultural heritage**, not just days off. I didn't understand until I watched elderly musicians play a melody that no book had ever recorded.

≈ **national treasures** — milliy boyliklar

≈ **ancestral legacy** — ajdodlar merosi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Sanalmaydigan ot: cultural heritage ('a heritage' emas). protect / preserve our cultural heritage. Rasmiy uslub; Part 3 uchun foydali.

Namuna gap: Festivals remind young people that they have a rich **cultural heritage** to protect.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

25 a sense of community

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

jamoa, mahalla ruhi • *the feeling that you belong to a group of people who help each other*

BAND 8 STORY

During Hayit, our mahalla feels like one big family. Neighbours carry plates of food to each other's gates, and **a sense of community** that I rarely feel in daily life suddenly fills the street.

≈ **a feeling of belonging** — tegishlilik tuyg'usi

≈ **community spirit** — jamoaviy ruh

Qachon ishlatiladi: a sense of community / belonging / pride. 'a sense of' dan keyin ot. Part 2 da bayramni yoqtirish sababi, Part 3 da ijtimoiy foyda sifatida.

Namuna gap: Local festivals create **a sense of community** among people who rarely meet.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

26 observe a custom

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

urf-odatga rioya qilmoq • *to follow a traditional practice carefully*

BAND 8 STORY

In our family we still **observe a custom** that my grandfather loved: before eating, the youngest child brings water to the oldest guest. It takes only a minute, but it shows respect, and visitors always find it touching.

≈ **follow a tradition** — an'anaga amal qilmoq

≈ **uphold a custom** — urf-odatni saqlamoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(fe'l) kuzatmoq, ko'rmoq — Scientists **observed** the stars all night.

Qachon ishlatiladi: observe a custom / tradition / holiday. Bu yerda 'observe' — rioya qilmoq ('kuzatmoq' emas). Rasmiyroq; Part 3 da an'ana haqida.

Namuna gap: Many families still **observe** this **custom** on the first day of spring.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

27 ancient rituals

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

qadimiy marosimlar • *very old ceremonies that follow a fixed pattern*

BAND 8 STORY

Jumping over a small fire is one of those **ancient rituals** that nobody can fully explain. We just know it's supposed to burn away bad luck, and every year the children shout with excitement.

≈ **age-old ceremonies** — asrlar osha marosimlar

≈ **long-standing rites** — uzoq yillik marosimlar

Qachon ishlatiladi: ancient rituals / customs / traditions. 'ritual' — marosim, ko'pincha ko'plikda. Madaniy mavzu; Part 3 da foydali.

Namuna gap: Some **ancient rituals** have survived for thousands of years.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

28 carry deep symbolic meaning

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

chuqur ramziy ma'noga ega bo'lmoq • *to represent an important idea, not just to be an object or an action*

BAND 8 STORY

The green sprouts on the table at Navruz **carry deep symbolic meaning**: new life, fresh hope and the end of winter. When I was little I thought they were just decoration, but now I find them beautiful.

≈ **symbolise renewal** — yangilanishni ramzlamoq

≈ **stand for hope** — umidni ifodalamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: carry symbolic meaning / significance. 'symbolic' — sifat, 'symbol' — ot. Rasmiyroq; Part 3 da bayram ahamiyatini tushuntirishda.

Namuna gap: Each colour in the costumes **carries deep symbolic meaning**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

29 stand the test of time

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

vaqt sinovidan o'tmoq • *to remain popular or useful for a very long time*

BAND 8 STORY

Some customs, like sharing bread with neighbours, have really **stood the test of time**. Technology changes, fashions change, but this small gesture still makes people feel that they belong.

≈ **last through the ages** — asrlar davomida saqlanib qolmoq

≈ **remain relevant** — dolzarb bo'lib qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: stand the test of time — idiom, neytral-rasmiy. Fe'l tartibsiz: stood. Part 3 da an'analar nega saqlanib qolgani haqida juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Good traditions **stand the test of time** because they meet real human needs.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

30 reconnect with your roots

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ildizlaringiz bilan qayta bog‘lanmoq • *to feel close again to your family history and culture*

BAND 8 STORY

My cousin grew up in Russia, and visiting our village for Navruz helped him **reconnect with his roots**. He learnt a folk song from my grandmother and cried a little when he sang it.

≈ **rediscover your heritage** — merosingizni qayta kashf etmoq

≈ **get back in touch with your culture** — madaniyatingiz bilan yana aloqa o‘rnatmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: reconnect with + one’s roots / heritage / culture. ‘roots’ ko‘plikda. Chet elda yashayotganlar yoki yoshlar haqida; Part 3 da.

Namuna gap: Festivals give young people a chance to **reconnect with their roots**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Feelings and why it matters (Part 2 reasons)

31 be in high spirits

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

kayfiyati ko‘tarinki bo‘lmoq • *to feel very cheerful and full of energy*

BAND 8 STORY

On the morning of Navruz, everybody in our house **was in high spirits**. My father was singing in the kitchen, which almost never happens, and even the neighbour’s cat seemed happier.

≈ **be in a great mood** — ajoyib kayfiyatda bo‘lmoq

≈ **be full of joy** — xursandchilikka to‘lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: be in high / good / low spirits — ‘spirits’ ko‘plikda. Hissiyotni ko‘rsatishga yordam beradi; Part 1 va 2 da.

Namuna gap: Everyone **was in high spirits** after the parade.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

32 let your hair down

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

dam olib, erkin quvnamoq • *to relax and enjoy yourself without worrying about being serious*

BAND 8 STORY

I work very long hours, so on holidays I love to **let my hair down**. Last year I sang karaoke with my cousins, badly, and for once I didn’t care what anyone thought.

≈ **cut loose** — erkin va quvnoq bo‘lmoq

≈ **have a good time** — vaqtni yaxshi o‘tkazmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom, norasmiy: let one’s hair down. ‘hair’ birlikda. Rasmiy matnda ishlatmang. Part 1 va 2 da bayramda dam olishni aytishga mos.

Namuna gap: Festivals give busy people a chance to **let their hair down**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

33 be filled with laughter and music

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

kulgi va musiqaga to‘lmoq • *to have a lot of happy sound in a place*

BAND 8 STORY

Our yard **was filled with laughter and music** until late, as children chased each other between the tables. I sat on the steps with a cup of tea and felt that life couldn’t get any better.

≈ **ring with laughter** — kulgidan sado bermoq

≈ **echo with music** — musiqadan sado bermoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: be filled with + ot (laughter, joy, the smell of ...). ‘filled by’ emas, ‘with’. Joyni jonli tasvirlash; Part 2 da yaxshi ishlaydi.

Namuna gap: The square **was filled with laughter and music** from morning till night.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

34 a much-needed break

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

juda zarur dam • *a rest from work or study that you really needed*

BAND 8 STORY

After a stressful exam month, the holiday felt like **a much-needed break**. I slept late, ate my aunt's pastries and didn't open a single textbook for three whole days.

≈ **a welcome change** — yoqimli o'zgarish

≈ **a well-deserved rest** — munosib dam

Qachon ishlatiladi: a much-needed + break / rest / holiday. 'much-needed' chiziqcha bilan. Charchoqdan keyin bayramning foydasi haqida; Part 2 va 3.

Namuna gap: For many workers, a public holiday is **a much-needed break**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

35 strengthen family bonds

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

oilaviy rishtalarni mustahkamlamoq • *to make relationships between relatives closer and stronger*

BAND 8 STORY

We only see our cousins once a year, at Hayit, but those few days **strengthen family bonds** more than months of phone calls. We cook together, argue about football and take one huge photo.

≈ **bring us closer** — bizni yaqinlashtirmoq

≈ **build stronger relationships** — mustahkamroq munosabatlar qurmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: strengthen / weaken family bonds / ties. 'bonds' ko'plikda. Part 3 dagi 'Why are traditional festivals important?' savolida juda foydali.

Namuna gap: Sharing meals at festivals **strengthens family bonds** across the generations.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

36 tears of joy

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

xursandchilik ko'z yoshlari • *crying because you are very happy*

BAND 8 STORY

When my father came home after a year abroad, my mother cried **tears of joy** at the door. We all joined her, and the neighbours came out to see why our house was so noisy.

≈ **happy tears** — baxtli ko'z yoshlar

≈ **be moved to tears** — ko'z yoshlarigacha ta'sirlanmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: cry / shed tears of joy. 'tears' ko'plikda. Hissiy daqiqalar haqida Part 2 da. 'joyful tears' demang.

Namuna gap: She shed **tears of joy** when she saw her whole family together.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

37 a lump in my throat

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tomog‘imga bir narsa tiqilib qolmoq • *a tight feeling in your throat when you are very emotional*

BAND 8 STORY

When the whole crowd sang the national anthem at the festival, I had **a lump in my throat**. I looked at my grandfather, who stood straight and proud, and I had to look away so nobody saw my eyes.

≈ **a tight feeling in my chest** — ko‘kragimda siqilish

≈ **be on the verge of tears** — yig‘lab yuborishga yaqin bo‘lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: have a lump in one’s throat. ‘lump’ birlikda. Kuchli hissiyotni aytishda; Part 2 oxirida juda ta’sirli chiqadi.

Namuna gap: I felt **a lump in my throat** as the fireworks started.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

38 an air of excitement

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

hayajon ruhi, hayajonli muhit • *a feeling of excitement that you can sense in a place*

BAND 8 STORY

There was **an air of excitement** in the whole town the night before Navruz. Shops stayed open late, kids ran with balloons, and even the bus driver was whistling a song.

≈ **a buzz of anticipation** — kutish hayajoni

≈ **an electric mood** — hayajonli muhit

Qachon ishlatiladi: an air of + excitement / mystery / celebration. ‘air’ — muhit ma’nosida; ‘an’ kerak. Part 2 da bayram arafasi tasvirida.

Namuna gap: **An air of excitement** hung over the village on the morning of the festival.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

39 feel a surge of pride

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

g‘urur to‘lqinini his qilmoq • *to suddenly feel very proud*

BAND 8 STORY

When our local dance group won first prize at the festival, I **felt a surge of pride**. I had watched them practise in the rain for months, so seeing them on stage felt like winning myself.

≈ **be filled with pride** — g‘ururga to‘lmoq

≈ **swell with pride** — g‘ururdan ko‘kragi kerilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: feel / experience a surge of + pride / joy / relief. ‘surge’ — to‘lqin, birdan paydo bo‘lgan his. Part 2 da his-tuyg‘uni kuchaytiradi.

Namuna gap: I **felt a surge of pride** as our flag rose above the stadium.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

40 be swept up in the excitement

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

hayajonga berilib ketmoq • *to become so involved in the happy mood of a crowd that you forget everything else*

BAND 8 STORY

I'm not a big dancer, but I **got swept up in the excitement** and joined a circle of strangers. Within minutes, we were holding hands and laughing as if we'd known each other for years.

≈ **get carried away** — o'zini unutib berilmoq

≈ **lose myself in the moment** — lahzaga berilib ketmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: be / get swept up in + ot (the excitement, the moment). Odatda passivda; 'swept' — sweep ning o'tgan zamoni. Part 2 da kayfiyat haqida.

Namuna gap: Everyone **was swept up in the excitement** of the final countdown.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Part 3: tradition, commercialisation and change

COLLOCATIONS 5 / 5

41 become increasingly commercialised

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

tobora tijoratlashib bormoq • *to be more and more about making money instead of old traditions*

BAND 8 STORY

When I was small, our festival was just a family picnic. Now shops start advertising discounts a month before, and it has **become increasingly commercialised**, which makes me a little sad.

≈ **turn into a money-making event** — pul topish tadbiriga aylanmoq

≈ **lose its authenticity** — haqiqiyligini yo‘qotmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: become commercialised (AmE: commercialized). ‘increasingly’ + sifat/fe’l shakli. Part 3 dagi ‘Are festivals too commercial?’ savoliga to‘g‘ridan-to‘g‘ri mos.

Namuna gap: Some argue that holidays **have become increasingly commercialised** because of online advertising.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

42 preserve cultural identity

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

madaniy o‘zlikni saqlamoq • *to protect the special customs and values that make a group of people different*

BAND 8 STORY

My aunt lives in Moscow, yet she cooks plov for every holiday and dresses her kids in atlas. For her, it’s a way to **preserve cultural identity** far from home.

≈ **protect our roots** — ildizlarimizni asramoq

≈ **safeguard national traditions** — milliy an’analarni himoya qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: preserve / protect / lose one’s cultural identity. Odatda ‘a’ siz ishlatiladi. Rasmiy uslub; Part 3 da tahlil qilishda kuchli.

Namuna gap: Traditional celebrations help communities **preserve their cultural identity**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

43 lose their original meaning

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

asl ma’nosini yo‘qotmoq • *to stop meaning what they first meant because people forget the reason*

BAND 8 STORY

For some teenagers, a festival is only a day to post photos online. The celebration has almost **lost its original meaning**, and few of them can explain why the holiday started.

≈ **lose their significance** — ahamiyatini yo‘qotmoq

≈ **become empty rituals** — quruq marosimga aylanmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: lose its / their original meaning: ‘its’ yoki ‘their’ ega bilan moslashadi. Part 3 da tanqidiy fikr bildirishda mos.

Namuna gap: Without education, some customs **lose their original meaning** within a few decades.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

44 die out

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

yo‘qolib ketmoq • *to slowly disappear completely*

BAND 8 STORY

Some village games that my grandfather played as a boy have almost **died out**. Nobody makes the wooden toys anymore, and the last craftsman in our district is over eighty.

≈ **fade away** — asta-sekin so‘nib ketmoq

≈ **disappear** — yo‘qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: die out — o‘timsiz phrasal verb: Traditions die out. Passivda ishlatilmaydi. Part 3 da an’analar yo‘qolishi haqida gapirishda tabiiy.

Namuna gap: If nobody teaches the dance, the custom may **die out**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

45 go through the motions

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ishtiyoqsiz, mexanik bajarmoq • *to do something without real interest because it is expected*

BAND 8 STORY

My cousin joins every family ritual, but he just **goes through the motions** while checking his phone. I think young people care more when they feel they have a real role, like cooking or leading a dance.

≈ **do something half-heartedly** — yarim ko‘ngil bilan qilmoq

≈ **lack real enthusiasm** — chinakam ishtiyoq yo‘q

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: go through the motions — ishtiyoqsiz bajarmoq. Salbiy ohang. Part 3 dagi ‘young people still care?’ savoliga muvozanatli javobda ishlating.

Namuna gap: Some teenagers only **go through the motions** at family gatherings.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

46 foster mutual respect

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zaro hurmatni rivojlantirmoq • *to help people respect each other by encouraging understanding*

BAND 8 STORY

A big international festival can **foster mutual respect** between communities. When visitors taste our food and learn our dances, they stop seeing us as strangers and start seeing us as neighbours.

≈ **promote tolerance** — bag‘rikenglikni targ‘ib qilmoq

≈ **encourage understanding** — o‘zaro tushunishni rag‘batlantirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: foster / promote mutual respect. ’mutual’ — o‘zaro. Rasmiy-akademik; Part 3 da bayramlarning ijtimoiy foydasi haqida.

Namuna gap: Multicultural festivals **foster mutual respect** among different groups.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

47 boost tourism

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

turizmni rivojlantirmoq • *to make more tourists visit a place*

BAND 8 STORY

The yearly folk music festival in our region **boosts tourism** every summer. Hotels are full, craftsmen sell more, and even small cafés extend their opening hours.

≈ **attract more visitors** — ko‘proq mehmon jalb qilmoq

≈ **bring in tourists** — turistlarni olib kelmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: boost tourism / the economy / sales. ‘boost’ o‘timli fe’l. Part 3 da bayramning iqtisodiy foydasi haqida; neytral uslub.

Namuna gap: Big cultural events can **boost tourism** in small towns.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

48 generate a lot of waste

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ko‘p chiqindi hosil qilmoq • *to produce a large amount of rubbish*

BAND 8 STORY

After the city’s New Year festival, the streets are covered with plastic cups and paper. Such events **generate a lot of waste**, and I think organisers should provide recycling bins and encourage reusable plates.

≈ **produce tons of rubbish** — tonnalab chiqindi chiqarmoq

≈ **leave a mess** — tartibsizlik qoldirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: generate waste / rubbish / income. ‘waste’ sanalmaydigan: a lot of waste. Part 3 da bayramning salbiy tomoni (ekologiya) haqida.

Namuna gap: Large festivals **generate a lot of waste** if they are badly organised.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

49 adapt to modern life

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

zamonaviy hayotga moslashmoq • *to change so that something still fits the way people live now*

BAND 8 STORY

Traditions survive only if they can **adapt to modern life**. Our village now streams its harvest festival online, and my cousins abroad can watch the dances live, so nobody feels left out.

≈ **move with the times** — zamon bilan hamnafas bo‘lmoq

≈ **evolve over time** — vaqt o‘tishi bilan o‘zgarmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: adapt to + ot (modern life, new conditions). ‘adapt to’ — ‘adapt for’ emas. Part 3 dagi ‘Do young people still care?’ savolida muvozanatli javob uchun.

Namuna gap: Customs that **adapt to modern life** are more likely to survive.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

50 a generation gap

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

avlodlar o‘rtasidagi tafovut • *a difference in attitudes between older and younger people*

BAND 8 STORY

There is sometimes **a generation gap** at festivals: my grandparents want long prayers and traditional food, while my cousins prefer pizza and music. Yet we usually find a compromise, and the table looks a bit funny.

≈ **a gap between old and young** — keksa va yoshlar o‘rtasidagi tafovut

≈ **differing attitudes between generations** — avlodlar qarashlaridagi farq

Qachon ishlatiladi: a generation gap (between A and B). ‘generation’ birlikda. Part 3 da yoshlar va an’ana haqida muhokamada.

Namuna gap: A **generation gap** can appear when young people find old rituals boring.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describe and explain

STRUCTURES 1 / 2

1 What I love most about + N is + N / that + S + V

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

... haqida menga eng yoqadigani ... bo‘ldi • *a cleft sentence that puts your favourite thing at the end for emphasis*

BAND 8 STORY

What I love most about Navruz **is** the feeling that winter has finally let go. Everyone cleans their house, cooks sumalak overnight and sings by the fire, and it feels as if the whole country takes a deep breath together.

≈ **The thing I enjoy most is ...** — Eng ko‘p zavq beradigani ...

≈ **What appeals to me most is ...** — Meni eng ko‘p jalb qiladigani ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 2 da sababni ta’kidlash uchun: What I love most about X is + ot / that-gap. ‘is’ dan keyin to‘liq gap ham mumkin. ‘It’ qo‘shmang.

Namuna gap: **What I love most about** festivals **is** that nobody seems to be in a hurry.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 It was not until + time + that + S + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

faqat ... dan keyingina ... • *emphasises that something happened late, only after a certain point*

BAND 8 STORY

It was not until I moved to Tashkent for university **that** I realised how special our village Navruz was. There the neighbours cooked in the street together, while in the city I only heard fireworks from my window.

≈ **Not until + S + V did + S + V** — faqat ... gachagina ... emas

≈ **Only after + N did + S + V** — faqat ... dan keyingina ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kechikkan anglash yoki kashfiyotni ta’kidlash. ‘that’ dan keyin oddiy so‘z tartibi. Part 2 hikoyalarida yaxshi burilish beradi; bir marta yetarli.

Namuna gap: **It was not until** I missed the celebration **that** I understood its value.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 Not only + did + S + V, but + S + also + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

nafaqat ..., balki ... ham • *an inversion after ‘not only’ that adds a second, surprising fact*

BAND 8 STORY

Not only did the festival fill our street with music, **but** it **also** brought back old neighbours I hadn’t seen for years. We sat in the yard and talked until the stars came out.

≈ **As well as + -ing, S + V** — ... bilan bir qatorda, ...

≈ **Besides + -ing, S + V** — ...dan tashqari, ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki faktni qo‘shishda: Not only did we ..., but we also ... Yordamchi fe’l oldinga chiqadi (did + asosiy fe’l). Bir javobda bir marta ishlating.

Namuna gap: **Not only did** we enjoy the parade, **but** we **also** learnt about its history.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 It was + N + that / who + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

aynan ... edi, ... shu ... edi • *a cleft sentence that stresses the exact person, thing or place*

BAND 8 STORY

It was my grandmother **who** taught me to bake non for Hayit. She never measured anything, yet it always turned out perfect, and I still try to copy the movement of her hands.

≈ **What + S + V + was + N** — ... ni qilgani ... edi

≈ **The one who ... was + N** — ... qilgan kishi ... edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Muhim detalni ajratib ko'rsatish: It was my aunt who ..., It was in Khiva that ... Odam uchun 'who', narsa va joy uchun 'that'. Hikoyada tabiiy.

Namuna gap: **It was** in the main square **that** the biggest celebration took place.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 far more + adj + than + N

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... dan ancha ko'proq ... • *a strong comparison that shows a big difference*

BAND 8 STORY

This year's Independence Day concert was **far more** impressive **than** I expected. There were drone lights, a symphony orchestra and thousands of people singing along.

≈ **much more ... than** — ... dan ancha ko'proq

≈ **considerably ... than** — ... dan sezilarli darajada

Qachon ishlatiladi: Taqqoslashni kuchaytirish: far / much / a lot + qiyosiy daraja + than. 'very more' deb xato aytmang. Part 2 va 3 da keng ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Traditional festivals are **far more** meaningful **than** shopping events.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 Such was + N + that + S + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

... shu darajada ediki ... • *a literary-style structure showing the strength of something*

BAND 8 STORY

Such was the crowd at the Sharq Taronalari concert **that** we had to watch from a rooftop. Even then, the music was so loud we could feel it in our chests.

≈ **So + adj + was + S + that ...** — shunchalik ... ediki ...

≈ **The ... was so ... that ...** — ... shunchalik ... ediki ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rasmiy-ta'sirli: Such was the + ot + that. 'Such is' hozirgi zamon. Part 2 da bir marta yetarli, ko'p ishlatilsa sun'iy eshitiladi.

Namuna gap: **Such was** the excitement before the holiday **that** nobody slept.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 Hardly had + S + p.p. when + S + V (past)

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ulgurmay, ... • *one action happens right after another, with inversion*

BAND 8 STORY

Hardly had the fireworks begun **when** a little girl next to me started clapping and shouting with joy. Her happiness was so contagious that the whole row of strangers joined in.

≈ **No sooner had + S + p.p. than ...** — ... bilanoq ...

≈ **The moment + S + V, ...** — ... lahzasida ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ketma-ket voqea: Hardly/Scarcely had + ega + p.p. WHEN (than emas). Hikoyadagi keskin burilish uchun; rasmiyroq, bir marta yetarli.

Namuna gap: **Hardly had** we sat down **when** the dancers appeared.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 I wish + S + had + p.p.

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

kashki ... qilgan bo'lsam • *expresses regret about something in the past*

BAND 8 STORY

I wish I had joined the folk dance when my cousin invited me. I stood at the edge feeling shy, and for weeks afterwards I watched the videos and regretted it.

≈ **If only + S + had + p.p.** — qaniydi ... qilgan bo'lsam

≈ **I should have + p.p.** — ... qilishim kerak edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: O'tmishdagi afsus: I wish + ega + had + p.p. 'I wish I would have' xato. Part 2 oxirida his-tuyg'u qo'shish uchun juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **I wish I had** taken more photos of the festival decorations.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 It is widely believed that + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

keng tarqalgan fikrga ko'ra, ... • *a passive reporting structure for a common opinion*

BAND 8 STORY

It is widely believed that Navruz has been celebrated for more than three thousand years. Whether or not the exact number is true, the rituals feel ancient, especially when people jump over a small fire.

≈ **... is widely regarded as + N** — ... deb keng tan olingan

≈ **People generally think that ...** — odamlar odatda ... deb o'ylaydi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da umumiy fikrni bildirish: It is widely believed / said / thought that ... Shaxsiy fikrni ehtiyotkorlik bilan aytishga yordam beradi; rasmiy.

Namuna gap: **It is widely believed that** festivals help people forget their problems.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 The more + S + V, the more + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qanchalik ... bo'lsa, shunchalik ... • *shows that two things increase together*

BAND 8 STORY

The more I learn about the meaning behind our customs, **the more** I enjoy them. Last year I asked my grandfather why we cook sumalak all night, and his answer made the whole evening feel different.

≈ **The harder ..., the better ...** — qanchalik qattiq ..., shunchalik yaxshi ...

≈ **As ... increases, so does ...** — ... ortgani sari, ... ham ortadi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Sabab-oqibat va tendensiya: The more people use X, the less they Y. Ikkala qismda ham qiyosiy daraja va 'the' bor. Part 3 uchun juda foydali.

Namuna gap: **The more** festivals become commercial, **the less** people remember their meaning.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 used to + V / would + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

avval ... qilardim • *describes past habits and repeated actions*

BAND 8 STORY

When I was little, we **used to** wake up at dawn on Hayit and run to the neighbours' houses for sweets. We **would** knock, shout 'Hayit muborak!' and collect so much candy that my pockets nearly tore.

≈ **I'd always + V** — doim ... qilardim

≈ **In those days, we ...** — o'sha paytlarda biz ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: O'tmish odatlari: used to (holat va odat), would (faqat takroriy harakat). 'would' holat fe'llari bilan ishlatilmaydi. Bolalik haqida Part 1 va 2 da.

Namuna gap: We **used to** gather in my grandfather's yard for every holiday.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 Only when / after + S + V + did + S + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

faqat ... dangina keyin ... • *inversion after 'only' to emphasise a late realisation*

BAND 8 STORY

Only when I saw my grandmother crying with happiness **did** I understand how important the reunion was. She held each grandchild's face and said she had waited all year for this moment.

≈ **Not until + S + V did + S + V** — faqat ... gachagina ... emas

≈ **It was only when ... that ...** — faqat ... da ... edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'Only when/after/then' bilan boshlangan gapda keyingi qismda inversiya: did I realise. Kechikkan anglashni ta'kidlaydi. Part 2 xulosa uchun.

Namuna gap: **Only after** moving abroad **did** she appreciate her home festivals.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

SAMPLE CUE CARD

Describe a festival or celebration.

Describe a festival or celebration.

You should say:

- what it is
- when it takes place
- what people do
- why you enjoy it

My 1-minute notes

- Navruz • 21 March • spring equinox • Uzbekistan
- clean the house • put up decorations • count down the days
- sumalak • folk dances • fairs • visit relatives
- mouth-watering feast • tug-of-war • let my hair down
- reasons: strengthen family bonds • sense of community
- wrap-up: cultural heritage • I wish I had recorded

SAMPLE ANSWER • BAND 8

I • Intro (what)

I'd like to talk about Navruz, the spring festival that we celebrate on the twenty-first of March in Uzbekistan. It is deeply rooted in tradition, and for me it's the most joyful day of the whole year.

P • When it takes place

As for the timing, it falls on the spring equinox, when the weather finally warms up and the trees start to blossom. Preparations begin weeks earlier: we clean the house, put up decorations in the yard and count down the days until the big night.

P • What people do

On the day itself, the streets come alive with music, folk dances and fairs selling handmade crafts. Women cook sumalak overnight, singing while they stir the pot, and in the morning we visit relatives and take part in the festivities in the park. Not only do we enjoy a mouth-watering feast, but we also play traditional games like tug-of-war.

E • Reason 1

The first reason I love it is that it strengthens family bonds. What I love most about Navruz is that even my cousins from other cities come home, and for one day nobody is checking their phones. We simply laugh, eat and let our hair down together.

E • Reason 2

On top of that, it gives me a sense of community. It was not until I lived abroad for a few months that I realised how special it is to see the whole street celebrating together. It helps keep a tradition alive that has been passed down from generation to generation.

W • Wrap-up

So, all in all, Navruz is far more than a day off for me. I wish I had recorded my grandmother's songs when she was younger, because that is cultural heritage no book can replace. Should you ever visit Uzbekistan in March, don't miss it.

UPGRADE YOUR TALK

Tell a story, not a list

Instead of…	Say…
very big celebration	a grand celebration
many people	huge crowds
special food	traditional delicacies
had fun	had a whale of a time
nice decorations	dazzling decorations
colourful clothes	vibrant costumes
happy atmosphere	a festive atmosphere
very old tradition	a time-honoured tradition
tourists come to see it	the festival draws visitors from all over the world
we do it every year	an annual ritual
sad when it ended	bittersweet when it ended
too expensive	prices go through the roof
too crowded	packed like sardines
lots of lights	the streets were ablaze with lights
dance	dance to traditional rhythms
shows	street performances
meet relatives	catch up with relatives
everyone helped	the whole neighbourhood pitched in
I like it a lot	I look forward to it all year
old customs	age-old customs
religious holiday	a sacred occasion
buy many things	go on a shopping spree
makes everyone happy	lifts everyone's spirits
I will not forget	cherish the memories
start of spring	welcome the arrival of spring